

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

"How did legal victories and grassroots action transform the struggle for civil rights?"

MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 1: THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE CIVIL RIGHTS MOVEMENT, 1954–60

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 80 Crucial Questions



⚡ Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

meoncross-history.netlify.app/units/usa/mastery_pack_KT1.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

-  **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
-  **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
-  **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

-  **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
-  **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
-  **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

KT 1.1: What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	Which laws enforced racial segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
2	What does the abbreviation NAACP stand for?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Which civil rights organisation was founded in Chicago in 1942 to champion non-violent direct action?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What primary method did the NAACP use in the early 1950s to fight racial inequality?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Why did Black Americans find it almost impossible to register to vote in the South in the early 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What was the doctrine established by the 1896 Plessy v. Ferguson Supreme Court ruling?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Why did the Congress of Racial Equality (CORE) choose to use non-violent direct action?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Who was the first Black American to head the NAACP Legal Defense and Educational Fund, coordinating early court battles?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Which US President issued Executive Order 9981 in 1948 to desegregate the United States Armed Forces?	☐	☐	☐	
10	What constitutional amendment, passed in 1868, contains the Equal Protection Clause used by the NAACP to challenge segregation?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
11	What term describes the local taxes citizens had to pay in order to vote, used to disenfranchise Black voters?	☐	☐	☐	
12	What tests were designed to prevent Black citizens from registering to vote by asking complex questions?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What was the main legal method used by the NAACP to challenge segregation in public education?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Which landmark Supreme Court case struck down the Texas 'white primary' voting restriction in 1944?	☐	☐	☐	
15	Why did many Black Americans face severe economic intimidation if they attempted to register to vote in the South?	☐	☐	☐	
16	Which of the following was the primary consequence of Southern states using literacy tests and poll taxes in the early 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which of the following best explains why the NAACP focused heavily on legal challenges through the courts in the early 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
18	Which of the following best describes the significance of the 1896 Plessy v. Ferguson ruling for the lives of Southern Black Americans in the early 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What was a major reason why World War II acted as a catalyst for the Civil Rights Movement in the early 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
20	What was the 'Double V' campaign popularised during the Second World War?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT 1.2: How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Which 1954 Supreme Court case declared segregation in public schools unconstitutional?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What was the name given to the group of Black students who integrated Central High School in Arkansas in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Who was the chief justice of the Supreme Court during the Brown v. Board ruling?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Who was the Governor of Arkansas who defied federal court orders and blocked school integration in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
25	Which elite military division was deployed by President Eisenhower to protect the Little Rock Nine?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Who was the lead NAACP lawyer who successfully argued the Brown case before the Supreme Court?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Why did President Eisenhower deploy federal troops (101st Airborne Division) to Little Rock in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What was the full name of the high school integrated in Little Rock?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What action did Governor Faubus take in 1958 to prevent further school integration?	☐	☐	☐	
30	Who was the first Black student to graduate from Little Rock Central High School?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What was the name of the 1955 Supreme Court order requiring	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	school desegregation 'with all deliberate speed'?				
32	Which 1950 Supreme Court case ruled that Texas must admit a Black student to its state law school?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Who was the first Black child to integrate an all-white elementary school in the South, in New Orleans in 1960?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Who was the local leader of the Arkansas NAACP who guided and supported the Little Rock Nine during the crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
35	Why was the 1954 Brown v. Topeka ruling alone insufficient to desegregate Southern schools?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Which of the following best explains why President Eisenhower sent the 101st Airborne Division to Little Rock in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What was the most significant consequence of the Little Rock Crisis on the civil rights movement?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What was the main consequence of the Supreme Court's 1955 Brown II ruling, which ordered desegregation to proceed 'with all deliberate speed'?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Which of the following was the primary cause of the Little Rock Central High School crisis in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
40	What famous psychological test was presented by Kenneth and Mamie Clark as evidence in Brown v. Board of Education to prove the emotional harm of segregation?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

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Date: _____

KT 1.3: How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Whose arrest on 1 December 1955 sparked the Montgomery Bus Boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
42	Which young minister was chosen to lead the Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) during the boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What does the abbreviation SCLC stand for?	☐	☐	☐	
44	How many days did the Montgomery Bus Boycott last?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Who was the Mayor of Montgomery who strongly opposed the boycott and joined the White Citizens' Council?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What logistics system did the MIA set up to allow boycotters to travel without using buses?	☐	☐	☐	
47	Which 1956 Supreme Court case declared bus segregation unconstitutional?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What percentage of Montgomery's daily bus passengers were Black before the boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Who was the local NAACP president in Montgomery who bailed Rosa Parks out and helped organize the boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
50	What non-violent strategy did the MIA use to force the bus company to desegregate?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What was the name of the Supreme Court ruling that declared segregation on public buses unconstitutional, ending the Montgomery Bus Boycott?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
52	Who was the 15-year-old Black girl arrested in Montgomery for refusing to yield her seat 9 months before Rosa Parks?	☐	☐	☐	
53	Which constitutional amendment's Equal Protection Clause was used to challenge bus segregation in Browder v. Gayle?	☐	☐	☐	
54	Who was the president of the Women's Political Council (WPC) who mimeographed 52,000 leaflets calling for a boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
55	What was the name of the women's political activist group led by Jo Ann Robinson in Montgomery?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Which of the following was the primary reason for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What was the most significant political consequence of the Montgomery Bus Boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Which of the following best describes the significance of the Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) in the boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What was the significance of the Supreme Court's decision in Browder v. Gayle for the Montgomery Bus Boycott?	☐	☐	☐	
60	On what date in December 1956 did Black residents of Montgomery officially end their boycott and return to integrated buses?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

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Date: _____

KT 1.4: Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What document signed by over 100 Southern congressmen in 1956 urged defiance of school integration?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Which segregationist group formed in Mississippi in 1954 to apply economic intimidation against civil rights?	☐	☐	☐	
63	Which white supremacist organization saw a major resurgence in the mid-1950s, using violence and bombings?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Which Southern Senator conducted a record-breaking 24-hour filibuster against the 1957 Civil Rights Act?	☐	☐	☐	
65	What was the main purpose of the Southern Manifesto, signed by over 100 Southern politicians in 1956?	☐	☐	☐	
66	Which US president signed the Civil Rights Act of 1957 into law?	☐	☐	☐	
67	What parliamentary delaying tactic did Southern senators (Dixiecrats) use to block civil rights bills?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What was the primary focus of the Civil Rights Act of 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
69	What was the main purpose of the Civil Rights Act of 1960?	☐	☐	☐	
70	How many Southern congressmen signed the Southern Manifesto in 1956?	☐	☐	☐	
71	What was the exact length of Strom Thurmond's record-breaking solo filibuster against the 1957 Civil Rights Act?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
72	Why did the murder of Emmett Till in 1955 become a major catalyst for the civil rights movement?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What term describes the conservative Southern Democrats who organized congressional resistance to civil rights?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What economic warfare method did the White Citizens' Councils use to punish civil rights activists?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Who was the 14-year-old Black boy from Chicago brutally lynched in Mississippi in August 1955 for allegedly whistling at a white woman?	☐	☐	☐	
76	Which of the following explains why the Civil Rights Act of 1957 was considered weak by civil rights leaders?	☐	☐	☐	
77	What was the main significance of the formation of the Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC) in 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Why was Mamie Till-Mobley's decision to hold an open-casket funeral for her son Emmett Till in 1955 historically significant?	☐	☐	☐	
79	Which of the following was the main cause for the creation of White Citizens' Councils across the South after 1954?	☐	☐	☐	
80	In what Mississippi town was the murder trial of Emmett Till's killers held in September 1955, resulting in an all-white jury acquitting them in just over an hour?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Date: _____

THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT 1.1: What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?

1. Jim Crow laws
2. National Association for the Advancement of Colored People
3. CORE (Congress of Racial Equality)
4. Legal action through the courts
5. Due to literacy tests, poll taxes, and white intimidation
6. Separate but equal
7. To expose the injustice of segregation to the public and force change
8. Thurgood Marshall
9. Harry S. Truman
10. 14th Amendment
11. Poll taxes
12. Literacy tests
13. Filing lawsuits in federal courts based on the 14th Amendment
14. Smith v. Allwright
15. Because white landowners and employers would fire or evict them
16. The systemic disenfranchisement of Black voters, preventing them from electing sympathetic local officials.
17. To establish binding legal precedents that could dismantle segregation nationwide.
18. It provided legal constitutional justification for segregation under the 'separate but equal' doctrine.
19. Black veterans returned home determined to fight racism in America after fighting for democracy abroad.
20. A campaign for victory over fascism abroad and victory over discrimination at home.

KT 1.2: How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?

21. Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka
22. The Little Rock Nine
23. Earl Warren
24. Orval Faubus
25. 101st Airborne Division
26. Thurgood Marshall
27. To protect Black students integrating Central High School from violent white mobs
28. Central High School

- 29. Closed all Little Rock high schools**
- 30. Ernest Green**
- 31. Brown II**
- 32. Sweatt v. Painter**
- 33. Ruby Bridges**
- 34. Daisy Bates**
- 35. Because it lacked a clear enforcement mechanism and timeframe**
- 36. To assert federal authority and enforce the Supreme Court desegregation order against state-level resistance.**
- 37. It demonstrated that federal intervention was necessary to overcome active Southern state resistance to integration.**
- 38. It allowed Southern authorities to exploit the vague phrasing to delay school integration for years.**
- 39. Governor Orval Faubus used the state's National Guard to block Black students from entering the school.**
- 40. The 'doll test', showing Black children preferred white dolls and saw Black dolls as inferior.**

KT 1.3: How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?

41. Rosa Parks
42. Martin Luther King Jr.
43. Southern Christian Leadership Conference
44. 381 days
45. W. A. Gayle
46. Carpool system
47. Browder v. Gayle
48. 70%
49. E.D. Nixon
50. Economic boycott
51. Browder v. Gayle
52. Claudette Colvin
53. 14th Amendment
54. Jo Ann Robinson
55. Women's Political Council (WPC)
56. The high level of community organization and the economic pressure of sustained Black boycotts.
57. It established non-violent direct action as a viable national tactic and elevated MLK to national leadership.
58. It coordinated community resources, carpools, and legal representation to sustain the long-term protest.
59. It provided the legal victory that forced Montgomery's buses to integrate, ending the boycott.
60. 21 December 1956, after the Supreme Court injunction took legal effect.

KT 1.4: Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?

61. The Southern Manifesto
62. White Citizens' Councils
63. Ku Klux Klan
64. Strom Thurmond
65. To oppose school integration and accuse the Supreme Court of abusing its power
66. Dwight D. Eisenhower
67. Filibuster
68. Voting rights
69. Federal inspection of local voter registration records
70. 101 congressmen
71. 24 hours and 18 minutes
72. Because his mother held an open-casket funeral to expose the brutality of racism

- 73. Dixiecrats**
- 74. Job dismissals and mortgage foreclosures**
- 75. Emmett Till**
- 76. It lacked robust enforcement mechanisms to verify voter registration and protect voters on the ground.**
- 77. It provided a coordinated, church-backed network for organizing non-violent protest across the South.**
- 78. It exposed the brutal reality of Southern white supremacy and galvanized national support for civil rights.**
- 79. To organize economic and political resistance to the Supreme Court's school desegregation rulings.**
- 80. Sumner, Mississippi.**

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 80 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/80)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...